FRAMEWORK
FOUNDRY
US EDITION · RESEARCH FOR THE SERIOUS INVESTOR

WEEK ENDING
Feb 28, 2026
US Edition

COVERAGE: EQUITIES · FIXED INCOME · COMMODITIES · MACRO · POSITIONING
US

The Week in Brief

Markets were mixed this week, with Gold leading at +2.15% and 10Y Treasury lagging at -2.70%. On the safe-haven front, Gold climbing 2.15% to $5,230.50 while the 10-year yield falling to 3.96% while the dollar weakening 0.08% to 97.57.

The macro picture was busy. Consumer Confidence (CB, February) came in above expectations (91.2 vs. 88.4). PPI (January 2026, MoM) came in above expectations (0.5% vs. 0.3%).

Looking ahead, the key events to watch are: ISM Manufacturing PMI (February), ISM Services PMI (February), Nonfarm Payrolls (February). Position sizing and hedges should reflect the potential for volatility around these releases.

Index Snapshot

LARGE CAP

S&P 500	-0.32%
Dow Jones	-1.13%
Nasdaq	-0.76%

BROAD MARKET

Russell 2000	-0.85%
Gold	+2.15%

FIXED INCOME

10Y Treasury	-11 bps

Market Snapshot

INDEX	CLOSE	WEEKLY %	WEEK RANGE
Gold	5,230.50	+2.15%	5,112.70 – 5,280.00
USD Index	97.57	-0.08%	97.28 – 97.94
S&P 500	6,878.88	-0.32%	6,815.43 – 6,952.51
Nasdaq	22,668.21	-0.76%	22,528.26 – 23,169.68
Russell 2000	2,632.36	-0.85%	2,600.99 – 2,679.61
Dow Jones	48,977.92	-1.13%	48,678.78 – 49,815.22
10Y Treasury	3.96	-11 bps	3.96 – 4.07

▲ Best: Gold (+2.15%)

▼ Worst: 10Y Treasury (-11 bps)

Last Week's Economic Events

DATE	EVENT	ACTUAL	EXPECTED	PREVIOUS	SURPRISE
2026-02-24	Consumer Confidence (CB, February)	91.2	88.4	89.0	Above
2026-02-27	PPI (January 2026, MoM)	0.5%	0.3%	0.2%	Above
2026-02-25	SCOTUS Tariff Ruling + New Tariff Announcement	--	--	--	Inline

📊 CONSUMER CONFIDENCE (CB, FEBRUARY)

Strong beat on consumer confidence driven by improved labor market optimism. The 2.2-point gain to 91.2 exceeded every analyst forecast, suggesting household spending resilience despite mounting tariff uncertainty. Positive for consumer discretionary (XLY) and financials (XLF). The Expectations sub-index rose sharply to 72.0, though it remains below the 80 threshold historically associated with recession risk.

📊 PPI (JANUARY 2026, MOM)

Wholesale inflation ran significantly hotter than expected, with core PPI surging 0.8% vs. 0.3% consensus â€" the largest monthly core gain in over a year. Broad-based services costs drove the miss. The hot PPI print reignited inflation fears and caused a sharp equity sell-off on Friday. Treasury yields rose across the curve. Watch the delayed PCE report (now rescheduled to March 13) for confirmation of whether producer-level price pressures are feeding through to consumers.

📊 SCOTUS TARIFF RULING + NEW TARIFF ANNOUNCEMENT

The dominant macro theme of the week: the U.S. Supreme Court ruled 6-3 to block President Trump's broad IEEPA-based global tariff authority. Trump responded by announcing a new blanket 15% global import levy, which came into effect midweek at 10%. Policy uncertainty spiked across all asset classes. Defensives (XLU, XLP) outperformed; import-sensitive cyclicals (XLY, XLI) underperformed. Watch for retaliatory measures from trading partners in coming weeks.

Upcoming Week

DATE	EVENT	IMPORTANCE
2026-03-02	ISM Manufacturing PMI (February)	High
2026-03-04	ADP Employment Change (February)	Medium
2026-03-04	ISM Services PMI (February)	High
2026-03-06	Nonfarm Payrolls (February)	High
2026-03-06	Unemployment Rate (February)	Medium

Positioning Tips

SIGNAL	SUGGESTED ACTION
Flash Manufacturing PMI on 2026-03-02	A key read on factory activity. Watch industrials (XLI) for directional cues.

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Past performance is not indicative of future results.